

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 7
 ♥ K 5 3
 ♦ A Q J 8
 ♣ 7 5 3

♠ A Q 8 2

♥ Q 10 9

♦ K 10 4

♣ A 10 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 9 6 4

♥ 7 4

♦ 9 6 3

♣ Q 8 4 2

♠ 5 3

♥ A J 8 6 2

♦ 7 5 2

♣ K J 9

West	North	East	South
1♦	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	3NT
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by North

The contract would be 4♥ played by South.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♦9. West wins the first trick with the ♦A, then plays ♦Q. You take your ♦K now, fearing that the next one could be ruffed by East.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 5

You hope West, who opened the bidding, (as East before the hands were rotated), will have the ♠K, which would reduce your losers to 4.

You win the second ♦ and play your ♥Q, taken by West with the ♥K. He cashes the ♦J, East following, then exits with a small ♥.

Win this trump and play one more, pulling West's last trump and ending in dummy. Play a ♠ to your ♠Q (which wins) then play ♠A and ruff a ♠ in dummy. West follows with the ♠7, ♠J and ♠K. Now you must try the ♣ finesse, but through whom?

Is it a 50-50 guess? Or is West more likely to have the ♣Q since he had the opening hand?

No, it is not a 50-50 guess. No, West doesn't have the ♣Q, East does. If you watched the cards that West has played you will realize he started with 3-3-4-3 distribution. You will also know that he started with 14 points outside the ♣ suit. If he had the ♣Q he would have a balanced 16 point hand and would have opened 1NT, not 1♦. So East has the ♣Q.

You can go through 100 hands and on 99 of them it won't matter if you pay attention to the cards played by the defenders or not.

But if you don't pay attention on all 100 of them you will miss the one time where your attention was needed.

The question is: Do you use Transfers after a 1NT OVERCALL? And in particular, can you bid the opponent's suit and have it mean a transfer instead of a cue-bid? This is something you and your partner need to agree on - as for me and my partner, we think 2♦ is a transfer. Partner replies 2♥.

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With 10 points you are between Invitational and Game-forcing. Which means you bid either 2NT or 3NT, whichever suits your fancy. Today let's say it is 3NT which partner converts to 4♥.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 2

♥ J 8 6

♦ A 3

♣ J 7 4 2

♠ 8 6 5 4

♥ A K 2

♦ Q 4

♣ A K 10 3



♠ A K 9

♥ Q 10 5 4

♦ J 10 9

♣ Q 8 6

♠ 7 3

♥ 9 7 3

♦ K 8 7 6 5 2

♣ 9 5

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♠

Pass

3♣

Pass

3♦

All Pass

3♦ by South

Loser List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = ? : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 3 + ?

Rather than trying to figure out how many losers this ♦ holding may produce, approach it from the other direction; you can only afford ONE loser, so you assume the cards lie in a way that will give you that result.

That means that the ♦s must be splitting 3-2, and it also means that you must knock out the ♦A without using either the ♦K or ♦Q. Can you do it?

Your only hope is for West to hold a doubleton ♦ A x. You ruff the third ♠, then play a small ♦ toward dummy's ♦Q. When this wins the trick, play another ♦, and duck in your hand. If West's ♦A falls you will be golden.

There are times when your only hope of making a contract is if the defender's cards lie in a particular way.

When this happens you should play as if they actually **DO** lie in that way, even though it may be against the percentages.

This hand is a perfect example - your only hope was for West to hold ♦ A x, so - you base your plan on West holding ♦ A x.

In the old days (before transfer bids) you could have just bid a "drop-dead" 2♦. But those days are gone so you must improvise. You bid 2♠, transferring partner to ♣s.

Partner says 3♣;

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Partner says 3♣;

You now bid 3♦ and partner knows to pass.

South plays 3♦. West leads the ♠Q. East overtakes and plays ♠A K 9.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 7 6 5

♥ 7 5

♦ K 10 9 4

♣ J 9 8

♠ J 4

♥ A 10 2

♦ A J 6 2

♣ A K 7 3



♠ 8 2

♥ K 9 8 6 3

♦ Q 7 3

♣ Q 10 4

♠ K Q 10 9 3

♥ Q J 4

♦ 8 5

♣ 6 5 2

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North